

Cost And Runway Plan

Target raise: about \$145,000 for a CTA-registration-first 12-month build/test runway.

Category	Basis	Amount
Founder development stipend	3,000/monthx12months	36,000
Segregated MNQ research/test capital	Held as strategy test capital	\$50,000
Databento live data estimate	179/monthx12months	2,148
StoneX simulation software	49.95/monthx12months, per provided fee schedule	599
Cloud/runtime/monitoring	EC2, logs, alerts, backups	\$2,000
Broker/API/exchange/commission/slippage allowance	StoneX commissions, exchange/regulatory fees, wires, and slippage buffer	\$10,000
NFA/Series 3/registration admin	Series 3, Form 7-R, AP/principal, CTA dues, fingerprint/admin buffer	\$2,500
CTA disclosure/legal/compliance/audit reserve	CTA registration-first counsel, disclosure document, NFA review responses, audit/accounting setup	\$30,000
Contingency	Unexpected data, infrastructure, and compliance costs	\$10,000

Planned budget total: \$143,247.

Regulatory Cost Assumptions

The registration budget separates official NFA-style fees from planning reserves. The disclosure/legal/compliance/audit reserve is intentionally larger than the hard filing fees because a usable CTA package needs counsel review, disclosure drafting, NFA response time, recordkeeping setup, and accounting/audit structure before any client-facing trading activity.

Item	Assumption	Source
NFA CTA Form 7-R application fee	\$200	NFA CTA registration requirements
NFA CTA initial/annual dues	\$750	NFA Membership Dues and Fees
Principal/AP application fee	\$85	NFA CTA registration requirements
Series 3 exam fee	\$140	NFA proficiency/exam guidance
CTA disclosure/legal/compliance/audit reserve	\$30,000	Planning reserve based on attached CTA/CTC cost note; counsel quote required

StoneX Fee Schedule Assumption

The following table uses the StoneX One fee schedule supplied by the founder for this draft. It has not been independently verified inside a live StoneX account, so counsel/account-opening review should confirm it before funding.

Item	Provided Schedule
Retail brokerage account minimum	\$2,000 baseline
Live simulation account minimum	\$5,000 baseline
Standard futures contracts	\$1.29 per side, per contract
Micro futures contracts	\$0.50 per side, per contract
StoneX Futures Platform	Free
Mobile app trading	Free
Simulation software	\$49.95/month

Domestic / international outbound wire 25/50
ACAT transfer out \$125
Inactive account fee \$100/year
Margin debit rate WSJ Call Money Rate + 2.50%

StoneX Commission Estimate For Current Models

The replay engine already embeds a \$1.50 per closed-unit audit fee. The table below compares that embedded audit fee to StoneX commission-only estimates using the supplied per-side rates. Exchange, NFA, clearing, market-data, margin-interest, wire, and slippage costs are not included in these commission-only rows.

System Closed Units StoneX Commission Model Audit Fee Delta
NQ Prior-Opposed Gated Intraday System 2,160 \$5,573 \$3,240 \$2,333
MNQ Prior-Opposed Gated Intraday System 2,140 \$2,140 \$3,210 \$-1,070
NQ Ungated Intraday Breakout System 6,900 \$17,802 \$10,350 \$7,452
MNQ Ungated Intraday Breakout System 6,886 \$6,886 \$10,329 \$-3,443

Runway Milestones

Month Milestone Required Evidence
1 CTA counsel kickoff and runtime hardening Structure memo, source manifest, reproducible research package
2 Series 3 / NFA ORS readiness and live-data shadow mode Exam/admin plan, stored live bars, no-trade signal reports
3 Disclosure document draft and broker-paper adapter Draft disclosure outline, broker order ids mapped to local intents
4 MNQ broker-paper trial Daily reports, slippage/cost audit, incident log
5 CQG/StoneX demo hardening and NFA response reserve Account/order reconciliation, restart drill, emergency flatten drill
6 First readiness review Feed integrity report, order sequencing audit, regulatory gap list
7 Extended MNQ funded-paper or small-live continuation Stable reports, variance-to-replay audit, risk-limit adherence
8 Ungated v2b paper comparison Secondary system replay-vs-paper evidence and operational differences
9 Reporting and investor portal draft Monthly packet, exposure report, drawdown explanation template
10 Robustness and regime review QQQ comparison refresh, bad-market behavior, filter review
11 Compliance/accounting package Counsel checklist, hypothetical-performance language, recordkeeping plan
12 Final go/no-go and tier decision Pilot report, registration/disclosure status, NQ tier decision only after MNQ evidence

Capital Treatment

- The \$50,000 MNQ research/test capital should be segregated from development spend.
- The NQ tier is not funded in this first runway; it remains a future tier after MNQ operations are stable.

- The MNQ test capital is internal research/test capital unless counsel confirms a compliant managed-account or advisory structure.
- Any client trading funds require CTA registration or a confirmed exemption, accepted disclosure/account documents if required, and broker/account approvals before acceptance.
- Canadian CTC/cross-border registration is not included in the base raise; it should be separately scoped if Canadian client activity is pursued.

Operating Cost Notes

- Databento live data is estimated from the current internal spec at \$179/month; commercial/non-display classification can raise the actual cost.
- StoneX account minimums and fee schedule should be confirmed inside the account-opening paperwork before live use.
- Broker/API/exchange fees must be confirmed inside the broker and data-provider portals before live use.
- Development stipend is included because the platform requires real engineering work: data ingest, order routing, reconciliation, reporting, deployment, monitoring, and documentation.